

MILESTONE B1 — FEEDBACK

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Case P5 — Profitability

Your mark: 67 /100

Developing. Your presentation is already at the standard; the investigation needs to catch up.

How the mark is made up

Criterion	Score	Weight
Technical correctness	2 / 4	35%
Business justification	2.5 / 4	25%
Documentation and readability	3.5 / 4	20%
Response to prior feedback	4 / 4	15%
Timeliness and integrity	1 / 4	5%

Scores are on the rubric's 4-point scale. Response to Prior Feedback carries full credit on B1, since there is no prior feedback yet — it becomes live from B2.

What you did well

You followed the required structure more closely than anyone else in the class. File, column, dimension, what you observed, rows affected, what it would break — exactly as the brief set out. That sounds like a small thing. It is not. A reader can trace every one of your findings back to a specific column in a specific file and go check it. Two of your classmates produced documents where that is impossible.

You wrote “I did not notice any dimension offended” for three files rather than inventing something. I want to be clear that this is a strength and not a gap. Manufacturing a finding to fill a row is a habit that ends careers in this profession. And you were right about branches.csv — it is genuinely clean. You are the only person who said so.

Every defect you did report carries an impact statement. Not one of them is just a count.

Part by part

Part A — Complete, with all required fields and accurate row counts. Same note as most of the class: your grain statements describe columns rather than the row. “One row represents each sale” should be “one row represents one product line on one sale” — and that distinction matters more than it sounds, which we will cover on Saturday.

Part B — Each question is mapped to a file, which helps. But there is no profitability question anywhere in your six — and profitability is your assigned case. That is the area you will present and defend in Week 11. Start asking those questions now, while the stakes are low.

Part C — Four defects. Accurate, well-explained, correctly classified — and too few. Two things to look at again. You recorded calendar.csv as having no defects; nine dates are missing from it, and that will break every year-on-year comparison in Week 10. And you wrote “unable to tell” for the inventory row count. When that happens, it usually means the profiler is still set to read only the first 1,000 rows. Change it to the entire dataset and the number appears.

Part D — Coherent, and you did the important thing: you said you would not publish those numbers without a note attached. That is the professional instinct the milestone is testing for.

Where to push next

- Set column profiling to the entire dataset, not the first 1,000 rows. The default is hiding findings from you.
- Open sales_transactions.csv properly. It is the largest file, it holds six defects, and you reported one.
- Ask a profitability question of every dataset you meet from now on. It is your case.
- Recompute at least one column by hand each time — quantity times price against the stated amount, for instance. Some faults only appear that way.

On the AI Use Log

Your submission carried no AI Use Log. If that is because you did the work yourself, without assistance, then say so — because that is worth something, and the honesty of this submission suggests it is true.

But the log was still required, and that is what the integrity score reflects — not the absence of AI, only the absence of the record. Even “No AI use on this milestone” is a complete and perfectly good entry.

And I would rather you did use it. This course teaches AI as a professional tool, not as something to avoid. Asking it what a data quality dimension means, or to explain an error message, or to check whether your reasoning holds — all of that is permitted and encouraged, and none of it needs approval. What is not permitted is asking it to inspect the files and hand you the defects. The line is between using it to think faster and using it to avoid thinking.

Submit a log for B1 and I will revisit that component of your mark.

You are strong at the part most students find hardest. Clear structure, honest reporting, findings a reader can act on — those are professional habits, and plenty of analysts never acquire them. What is missing is depth, and depth is mostly a matter of spending longer in the file and being more suspicious of what you see.

That is the easier direction to be short in. A thorough investigator who cannot write it up is a hard problem. A clear writer who needs to dig deeper just needs to dig deeper.

Go further into the data next time. The reporting will already be waiting for it.

— Sir Jerald

Questions about any of this? Message me, or bring it to consultation. I would rather explain a mark than have you guess at it.